Preparing for the In-Class Midterm

> ⚠ Under Construction
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> You are reading an **early draft** of the Practice Midterm! I want to make it available for eager beavers who are particularly worried about what the Midterm might look like, but I will announce over Canvas (and remove this message) when the final version is ready for you to work through.

The **in-class midterm** will be held on the following days, based on your section:

- **Section 01:** Monday, November 2, 2026
- **Section 02:** Thursday, November 5, 2026

The purpose of the midterm is twofold:

- First, to assess your comprehension of the course topics from Weeks 1 through 8, and their interrelationships, as they relate to the goals of modern data-driven organizations
- Second, to perform this assessment not in the abstract but via the development of a **concrete plan** that will then serve as a key step in your Final Project!

Your first step, in preparing for the midterm, is to **read through the dataset vignettes** and decide which one is most interesting to you. Once you have decided, **register your decision on Canvas** by choosing an option within the "Midterm Dataset Choice" assignment.

Finally, you can think through how the following "pieces" of what we've learned up to this point in the course would work relative to your chosen dataset!

Question 1: OLTP Infrastructure

This question is **started for you** in the vignette for your chosen dataset, where (in the subsection with header "OLTP Structure") you can get a sense for the **existing OLTP infrastructure** at the organization you've been hired at. In each case, your job is to think through **transforming** the information in this OLTP setup into the kinds of insights/inferences described at the beginning of the vignette.

Question 2: Ingesting, Transforming, and Loading OLTP Snapshots

Question 3: OLAP Infrastructure

Question 4: Querying OLAP Data

Question 5: Scaling OLAP Queries

Question 6: Serving and Reporting Our Scaled OLAP Query Results